

Figure 3: LaTeX's features

It is easy to understand the source of the LaTeX article. The major benefits of using LaTeX are listed below.

- It can be used to create journal articles, reports, books, theses, etc. LaTeX is very good in handling larger sized content. With the traditional word processing tools, managing a 300-page document with many tables and figures can be tricky. Even a simple change in one place will have difficult-to-track cascading effects in various other places. In the case of LaTeX, the professional rendering of content with proper alignment is now the task of the LaTeX engine and authors need not worry much.
 - Managing linked references is very simple. For references, you can explore BibTex.
 - If your document consists of mathematical formulae, then LaTeX should be your first choice. The rendering of formula and other scientific notations/symbols is handled excellently by LaTeX.
 - LaTeX offers support for managing many languages. For multi-lingual documents, LaTeX can be very handy.
 - Incorporation of pictures/images and their alignment issues are handled professionally by LaTeX.
- LaTeX supports all major platforms. The LaTeX installation instructions are available at <https://www.latex-project.org/get/>. If you don't want to install it in your system, there are online tools available. Some of them are listed below:

- Papeeria
- Overleaf
- LaTeXBase

Online tools such as Overleaf make collaborative LaTeX writing simple and effective. If you work as a team, then definitely it is worth giving them a try. The Beamer component of LaTeX helps you to create presentations. As stated, for documents, the presentations created using Beamer would be perfect in terms of style and formatting consistency across all the slides.

Building graphical illustrations

Making good quality, meaningful graphical illustrations is another important task for scholars. There are many diagramming tools available for this purpose. This article

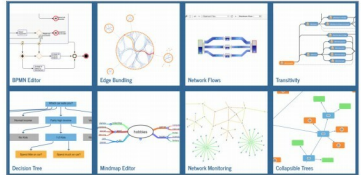


Figure 4: yEd layouts

introduces you to a tool named **yEd** (<https://www.yworks.com/products/yed/>), which is freely available on all major operating systems such as Windows, GNU/Linux, Mac, etc. yEd allows you to build various types of diagrams such as:

- Flowcharts
- Family trees
- Semantic networks
- Social networks

A gallery of diagrams supported by yEd is available at <https://www.yworks.com/products/yed/gallery>.

yEd can be either installed in your system or a live online version can be used.

Automatic Layout is an important feature provided by yEd. The algorithms in yEd can be used to lay out the diagrams in various layouts by simply clicking a button. Some of the popular layouts are listed below:

- Hierarchical
- Orthogona
- Organic
- Circular
- Tree

Networking and collaboration tools

Networking is important for a good scholarly researcher. Information technology tools make it easy to communicate and collaborate with peers. In addition to the normal social networking tools used by everyone, there are some specific options for researchers to communicate and collaborate. A few of them are listed below.

Academia (<https://www.academia.edu/>): Academia is a free and simple way to share your research. One of the advantages of using this collaboration tool is that by reaching the right peer, there is a better possibility of increasing the citations.

Researchgate (<https://www.researchgate.net/>): Researchgate is a simple and effective platform to share your research papers and details about the projects that you are working on. It enables you to gather insights into your peers' work at the global level, and get hints on the progress of their current research projects.